network had to be pressed into operation to ensure proper communication between the participants for we had no single place to accommodate al the invitees. This was the second most significant day in my career, next only to 18 July 1980, when the SLV-3 had launched Rohini into the earth's orbit.

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**11**

**Stewards**

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he launch of the IGMDP was like a bright flash on the Indian scientific firmament. Missile Technology had been considered the domain of a few selected nations in the world. People

were curious to see how, with what India had at that point of time, we were going to achieve al that was promised. The magnitude of the IGMDP was real y unprecedented in the country and the schedules projected were quite quixotic by the norms and standards prevailing in the Indian R&D establishments. I was ful y aware that obtaining sanction for the programme could at best be seen as only ten per cent of the work done. To get it going